to realities experienced elsewhere. He thinks that there are two varieties of perception: a pre-linguistic and pre-conceptual (*nirvikalpa*) undifferentiated observation, comparable to the awareness of babies and the mute, of the object as an undifferentiated whole; this may be followed by a conceptual awareness involving an explicit grasp of the object in its individuality with its real properties including its generic form (***akriti***).

The absolute validity of the beginningless, authorless (*apaurusheya*) and infallible *Vedic* scriptures commanding ritual performances follows from the simple fact that they are perceived. They are our only means of knowing about that which lies outside experience, revealing something that would otherwise be unknown.

The relation between a *Vedic* word and its referent is direct, innate and constant. Such words primarily stand for everlasting generic properties (***samanya***) expressed in natural kinds (***jati***) and generic structures (***akriti***) of individuals. This is why and how they may also apply to individual entities (***vyakti***).

Kumarila accepts that language may express facts (*siddha*) as well as things to be done (*sadhya*). But the only type of language that is a source of knowledge in its own right is that of the *Vedic* ritual instructions (*vidhi*) because what is factual is already established by perception and inference. In accordance with the maxim, 'Not even the stupid act without some end in view', *Kumarila* thinks that the *Vedic* imperatives (*vidhi*) only motivate people who have an interest in the promised results of prescribed actions.

See ***anupalabdhi-pramana***, ***jnatata***, ***Prabhakara Mishra***

Further reading: Halbfass 1991; Hiriyanna 1993; Jha 1964